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Submitter Information

Name: Thomas Bessette

[REDACTED]
[REDACTED]

General Comment

As an author in several networks with other authors, as well as artists, filmmakers, and several other creative industries, I strongly urge the United States government and the Trump administration to uphold creatives' copyright and IP rights, and ensure that generative AI models cannot train on copyrighted works without proper licensing and compensation. Generative AI already poses a great threat to workers' rights and livelihoods in creative industries such as film and video gaming. The creative industries of the United States are a cornerstone of its cultural exports and economy, and have done great work over the decades in building America's reputation as a land of economic and personal freedom. This is why it's important we protect the rights and livelihoods of the people in these industries, and why we should not undermine copyright just for the benefit of the AI industry. Artificial intelligence can and should be a benefit for all sectors of the economy, and many artists and writers wish to leverage artificial intelligence in a way that benefits the arts without harming people's livelihoods. By enforcing copyright licensing for companies looking to use copyrighted material to train their AI models, we can ensure that workers can continue to produce media for the entire world to enjoy while also allowing for technological advancement in a way that is mutually beneficial and positive-sum. The future doesn't need to be a zero-sum game where some industries are financially ruined by others, but a mutually cooperative future is only possible by upholding the laws of the country. Copyright law is an important cornerstone of the law that drives innovation in all sectors, but removing copyright protections because of tech companies' demands would not only harm creative industries, but it would be a massive blow to all industries that rely on intellectual property in the United States, which in turn would also harm its technology industries, including companies like Google and OpenAI who are lobbying for reduced copyright protections. This is why I urge the United States federal government and the Trump administration to uphold copyright law, protect people's intellectual property rights, and ensure that artificial intelligence is trained and developed in a way that is mutually beneficial for the entire economy and does not plunder the intellectual property of other sectors without any compensation.